

Facebook Malware

Bitdefender claims one in five users on Facebook have malware on their newsfeeds

About.me

AOL takes over recently started up profile landing site called About.me

Bazaar

Canon EOS 60D

The fence straddler

After the excellent EOS 7D that introduced a host of new features, it was only a matter of time before Canon trickled this technology downwards, into lower-end bodies. The 60D is exciting because, like the lower-end EOS 550D, it features a lot of the goodness of the EOS 7D at a slightly lower price point.

The 60D is visibly smaller than the EOS 7D, and the top is lower, owing to a slightly smaller pentaprism bulge. The rubber coating on the 60D feels a little less meaty. The magnesium alloy frame is dropped for a more conventional polycarbonate body, and the LCD gets a polycarbonate coating, rather than the hard glass surface on the 7D. On its own, the 60D feels solid in-hand, definitely a lot chunkier than the EOS 4xx/5xx series of camera bodies. The buttons and keys on the body are well built and particularly the main dial.

The battery compartment is small since it holds an SD card, and not the larger CF variety. The battery is hefty, the same one as the EOS 7D, rated at 1,800 mAh. Canon states battery life to be over 1,000 shots, we found that clicking some 150 shots with flash used one fifth of the time hardly drained any juice, and the battery still showed 80 per cent charge - pretty good.

The LCD viewfinder is pretty good, in fact about as good as we've seen. The 1,040,000 dot display means its plenty sharp, and crisp, and minimal zooming is required



to check sharpness of an image. Incidentally, burst mode will have the first flurry of photos taken quickly, then, as the camera runs out of available buffer, the speed slows down till the buffer has written enough to the memory card to accept more data. The kit lens offers good sharpness, reasonable even in the corners, especially considering the lens is available for around `6,000. The 60D is slower than the 7D across the board. Live view is slower, toggling between image mode and video mode is slower with the display blacking out for a whole one and a half seconds. Focussing is also slightly slower, and in lower light, this becomes more noticeable. Where speed is critical to get or miss a shot, the 7D should be preferred. However, even with one Digic 4 processor less, the 60D is no slouch in its own right. Camera on to shot is extremely fast, and in less than a second, you can click off a shot.

The 60D is capable of producing excellent results, in fact the output of the 60D is clean, neutral and full of details. One

of the advantages of cramming 18 megapixels on to a smaller 1.6x crop sensor is the sharpness. The 60D produces very sharp images in good and mediocre lighting. There is a lot of detail visible and the high resolution helps. The tradeoff is usually lower performance in low-light, owing to high density of photodiodes, but the 60D survives this technical restriction rather well. Even in low light, and higher ISO's, images retain a lot of detail - it's obvious that the 7D sensor is working its magic on the output of the 60D as well. Even at ISO 1600, the 60D manages a lot of detail, with some smearing of detail happening in darker regions of the image, and with a bit of grain. At ISO 3200, the 60D leaves the 50D behind by a big margin, proving that a current-gen, 18-megapixel is a lot better than a 15-megapixel unit of yesteryear. If you shoot in RAW, you will be able to extract even more detail.

At Rs. 77,195, for the body and a 18-55 kit lens, the 60D is costlier than what we expected. It is a very competent camera, offering very good image quality and equally impressive low-light performance.

Specifications

Sensor: 18-megapixel CMOS
22.3 x 14.9 mm ; Focussing:
9-cross point; 3-inch,
10,40,000 dots; weight:
755 g; battery: 1800 mAh

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Price: ₹77,195 (MRP, Body +
18-55 Lens)

7.0
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Features.....	8.0
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	7.5
Value for money	6.5